Actor Shares New Details About an Unmade Ben Affleck Batman Movie

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For years, fans have wondered about "The Batman," a movie starring Ben Affleck that was never made. Now actor Joe Manganiello has shared new details in his **memoir**, "Bloodlines."

Manganiello was set to play the movie's main **villain**, Slade Wilson, also known as Deathstroke. Some details were already known. Deathstroke would have been seeking **revenge** by trying to ruin Bruce Wayne's life. The story was inspired by director David Fincher's film "The Game," and Barbara Gordon, also known as Batgirl, would have appeared.

The new detail confirms a longtime rumor. According to Manganiello, the **villain** would have killed Gotham City Police **Commissioner** Jim Gordon, played by J.K. Simmons. Gordon is Barbara's father and one of Batman's most loyal **allies**. That helps explain Batgirl's role: she would have wanted to stop the **villain** who took her dad.

Manganiello also described a big action scene in the middle of the movie. Deathstroke would have nearly beaten Batman and Batgirl before the two heroes escaped on an above-ground train.

Simmons first played Gordon in "Justice League." That film included a scene where Slade meets Lex Luthor on a yacht. In "Zack Snyder's Justice League," Lex gives Slade Batman's secret identity, a scene meant to set up Affleck's movie.

Because the movie was never made, no one can know for sure how it would have turned out. If it had moved forward, the story might have been rewritten.

The /Film article notes that a similar **storyline** is happening now in the comic series "Absolute Batman." There, Gordon also dies and Batman is wrongly blamed. Barbara Gordon doubts that Batman did it and becomes a hero called "the Bat." The writer argues that Gordon matters so much because he has long been Batman's most trusted friend.

Word Treasure

memoir -- A book in which a person tells true stories from their own life.
villain -- The bad guy in a story.
revenge -- Hurting someone back because they hurt you first.
Commissioner -- The leader of a city's police department.
allies -- People or groups who support and help each other.
storyline -- The plot or series of events in a story.

Background you need

Batman is a DC Comics superhero, the secret identity of Bruce Wayne, who protects Gotham City.

Jim Gordon is Gotham's police commissioner and a longtime ally of Batman, and his daughter Barbara often appears as the hero Batgirl.

Movie studios sometimes plan films that are later canceled, and actors may later share what the story would have been.

Comic books often retell famous characters in new versions, like the "Absolute Batman" series.

Break it down

LEAD: Joe Manganiello's memoir reveals new details about Ben Affleck's unmade "The Batman"

KNOWN BEFORE: Deathstroke sought revenge on Bruce Wayne; Batgirl would appear

NEW DETAIL: The villain would have killed Commissioner Jim Gordon, played by J.K. Simmons

+- PLOT LINK: Explains Batgirl's role in the story

+- ACTION: Batman and Batgirl escape Deathstroke on an above-ground train

SETUP: A "Zack Snyder's Justice League" scene was meant to lead into the film

COMPARISON: A similar storyline appears in the comic "Absolute Batman"

OPEN QUESTION: Would the story have been rewritten if the film had moved forward?

Why it matters

The story shows how movie plans change and how writers use important characters to raise the stakes in superhero stories.

Test what you remember

1. What is the name of Joe Manganiello's memoir?

- (A) Justice League
- (B) The Game
- (C) Bloodlines
- (D) Absolute Batman

2. Which villain was Manganiello set to play?

- (A) Deathstroke
- (B) Lex Luthor
- (C) The Joker
- (D) Scarecrow

3. According to Manganiello, which character would have been killed in the movie?

- (A) Lex Luthor
- (B) Bruce Wayne
- (C) Batgirl
- (D) Commissioner Jim Gordon

4. How did Batman and Batgirl escape in the planned action scene?

- (A) In a helicopter
- (B) On motorcycles
- (C) By boat
- (D) On an above-ground train

5. Who first played Jim Gordon in "Justice League"?

- (A) Joe Manganiello
- (B) Ben Affleck
- (C) J.K. Simmons
- (D) David Fincher

6. In the comic series "Absolute Batman," what does Barbara Gordon become?

- (A) A news reporter
- (B) A hero called the Bat
- (C) A police commissioner
- (D) A villain

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: A 3: D 4: D 5: C 6: B

Questions to think about

1. Joe Manganiello: Says in his memoir that the villain would have killed Jim Gordon in the film.

2. The /Film writer: Argues Gordon matters so much because he has long been Batman's most trusted friend.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):